

He said, “No reason; we just don’t want you here.”

So we left.

The next day, on our drive home, the accelerator locked in the down position on a mountain road, and the car couldn’t be stopped. The car sped up to 80 on this curvy mountain road.

It sounds like straight out of a movie.

It does [he laughs]. I had the presence of mind to downshift as much as I could, turn off the key, step on the brake and pull out the emergency brake. I was able to bring the car to a stop. We had a flag on the car, and a Good Samaritan who knew about cars stopped to help us. He looked under the hood and said, “I have never seen anything like this accelerator rod.” Something had fallen off to make the accelerator rod lock down. He was able to temporarily fix it so that we could drive home.

I guess the other passengers in the car must have been quite panicked.

Well, we could have been killed.

Why would the casino have tampered with your car after they had already banned you from the premises?

I can’t tell you it was tampered with; all I can tell you is what happened.

We got off on a tangent. I had asked you about how you made the transition from casino games to markets.

After my successful casino games—I also developed a system for beating Wheel of Fortune—I got to thinking about games in general and thought, *The biggest game in the world is Wall Street. Why don’t I look at and learn about that?*

I knew almost nothing about the market. In 1964, I decided to spend the summer learning about the stock market. I read everything from Barron’s to books such as the *Random Character of Stock Prices*. After a summer of reading, I had a lot of thoughts about what to do and what to analyze.

Were any books particularly helpful?

Most of them were helpful in the negative. For example, *Technical Analysis* by Edwards and McGee was very helpful in the negative.